
Scopus AI

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Summary

Scopus AI is a literature search and summarization tool that uses a customized large language model, a form of artificial intelligence (AI), to [develop search queries](#) and generate [textual and visual summaries](#) of literature. Northeastern University has a subscription to Scopus AI. If you are associated with Northeastern, you can [log in using your university email and credentials](#).

This handout provides a guide to Scopus AI's primary capabilities. The impacts of generative AI and the range of its capabilities are rapidly changing, so please be aware that any information provided here should be taken in tandem with your current knowledge of these subjects. Please also note that you should follow your professor's stated guidelines for AI use in your class. For more information on Northeastern University AI policies as well as AI tutorials and tips, visit the [Northeastern Center for Advancing Teaching and Learning Through Research](#).

AI Ethics

AI ethics are a large and complex topic. Before you use an AI tool, consider how it derives information, what/whom its sources are, what information it is privileging or leaving out, which resources are depleted by its use, and which communities are harmed in its development and use. For more information on AI ethics and bias as they pertain to literature reviews, please see our [AI for Literature Reviews slides](#).

Strengths and Weaknesses

Scopus AI can be a useful tool for broadening your understanding of themes in literature on a topic spanning multiple fields. However, it is still necessary for researchers to critically evaluate the search results to identify which are relevant and to follow up with targeted searches, including in [other databases](#).

Digital Integration Teaching Initiative

Strengths

- Queries can be entered in [languages other than English](#)
- Can identify a [wider range](#) of relevant sources from other disciplines than a traditional keyword search
- Draws from a variety of [peer-reviewed](#) sources including books, articles, conference papers, and reports
- AI assisted search [displays the steps](#) taken in gathering and summarizing literature and queries are [not used to train ChatGPT](#)

Weaknesses

- Quality of results is impacted by [search specificity](#)
- Researchers may be [overwhelmed by the breadth](#) of results
- Results may be biased toward [Elsevier journals](#)

Using Scopus AI

When using Scopus AI, it is important to carefully evaluate the results and the steps that the AI model took to generate the results, as well as to follow up with additional searches.

1. Go to <https://www-scopus-com.ezproxy.neu.edu/pages/home#basic> and log in using your Northeastern credentials.
2. Select **Scopus AI** under **Start exploring**.
3. Enter your research question (you may need to sign in again to save your search).
Specific research questions focused on summarizing existing literature (such as “What are the strengths and weaknesses of using AI powered tools to support conducting a literature review?”) may generate more relevant results than general questions (such as “Is AI useful for research?”). You can also include contextual information, such as “Focus on studies published after 2023,” to increase the relevance of results. If you prefer, you can enable **Deep research**, which is a setting that generates a report including research gaps and recommended next steps. Note that if you enable **Deep research**, the options to create a **Concept Map** and view **Topic Experts** and **Emerging Themes** may not be available until you ask a follow up question.

Start exploring

Documents Authors Researcher Discovery Organizations **Scopus AI** New

Explore topics and discover relevant references since 2003

Ask research questions to generate a detailed report, try being very specific.

☒ Deep research →

Caption: Scopus AI landing page, including text box for research question.

- Review research steps by clicking **Thought for...** in the upper left corner. These steps can provide insight into potential keywords to be used in subsequent searches.

The screenshot shows the Scopus AI interface. At the top, it says "AI powered tools for literature review". Below this, a text box contains the question: "What are the strengths and weaknesses of using AI powered tools to support conducting a literature review?". To the right of the text box, there is a "Thinking Details" panel. This panel lists the steps the AI took to generate the results:

- I'm currently researching how to best measure the accuracy and reliability of AI tools in literature screening.
- I've found 20 sources related to how effective hybrid human-AI workflows are compared to fully manual or fully automated literature reviews.
- I'm currently researching the fifth question about ethical frameworks for bias and accountability in AI-assisted literature.
- I've found 20 sources related to the advantages of various AI-powered literature review tools.
- I've found 20 sources related to how generative AI models manage hallucinations and inaccuracies in literature summaries.

Caption: **Thinking Details** showing the steps by which the AI retrieved the results.

- Review results. To show the reference supporting each result, click on the reference number displayed under **Supporting Citations**.

AI powered tools for literature review

What are the strengths and weaknesses of using AI powered tools to support conducting a literature review?

Deep research - Thought for 2min 3sec

AI powered tools for literature review

[View as PDF](#)

Strengths and Weaknesses of AI-Powered Tools in Supporting Literature Reviews

Quick Reference

Key Findings Table

Aspect	Strengths	Weaknesses	Supporting Citations
Efficiency & Workload	Rapid screening, extraction, synthesis: significant time and	Risk of hallucinations, inconsistent outputs, need	1 2 3 4

Deep research reference

Reference 1 • 1 citation

Literature Review as a Service: A Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence Approach

Le Dinh, T. ㄱ, Le, T.D. ㄱ, Uwizeyemungu, S. ㄱ, Nguyen, C.N. ㄱ

ACM International Conference Proceeding Series ㄱ 2024

[Open document details](#)

Abstract

Nowadays, the use of generative artificial intelligence (AI), such as chatGPT and other AI-powered tools, has a significant impact on conducting research projects.

Caption: Reference information for supporting citation.

- To view all references, scroll to the end of the response and click **Show all references**.
- Click **View as PDF** and save results.
- After you have performed an initial search, you can ask follow up questions and select **Show Copilot steps** to review how the follow up search was performed. Reviewing the Copilot steps can help you identify keywords to use in further searches.

What ethical frameworks have been applied to the issue of AI bias in literature reviews?

[Hide Copilot steps](#) ^

☑ Creating a plan to answer your query

☑ Performing natural language search:

- What ethical frameworks have been applied to AI bias in literature reviews?

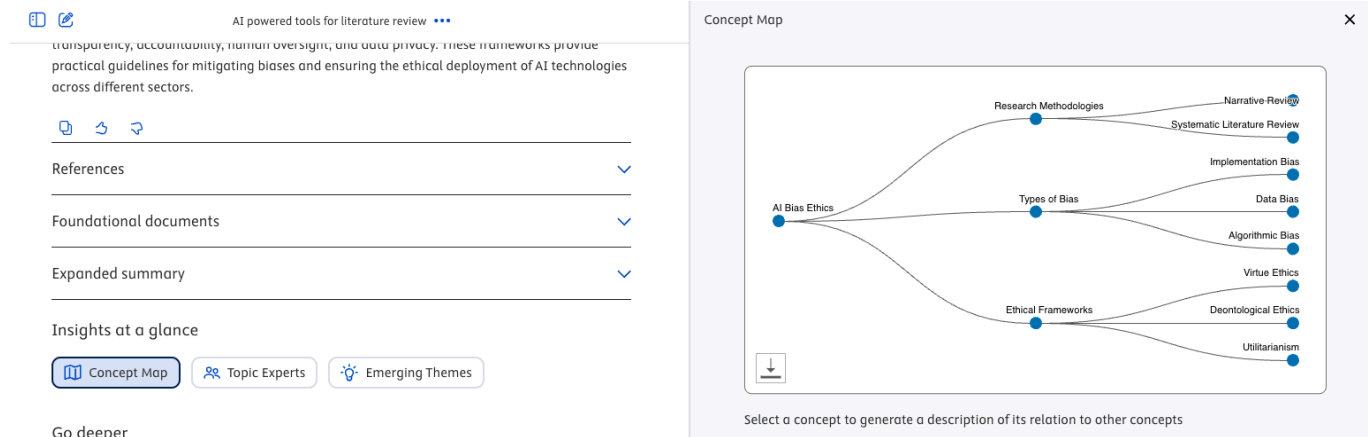
☑ Performing keyword search:

- ("ai" OR "artificial intelligence" OR "algorithm") AND ("bias" OR "prejudice" OR "discrimination" OR "inequity") AND ("literature review" OR "systematic review" OR "review" OR "meta-analysis") AND ("methodology" OR "approach" OR "framework" OR "analysis") AND ("data" OR "information" OR "evidence" OR "findings")

☑ Generating summary

Caption: Copilot steps used to answer the question, “What ethical frameworks have been applied to the issue of AI bias in literature reviews?”

9. Review the **Concept Map**, **Topic Experts**, and **Emerging Themes** to identify potential directions for continuing your literature review.



Caption: Concept map generated from literature results.

10. After you have performed an initial search with Scopus AI, we recommend performing [additional searches in other databases](#).

Further Resources

- [AI at Northeastern University](#), Northeastern Information Technology Services
- [Education literature review search strategies: AI and Library resources](#), Lindley Homol, Northeastern
- [Research Tutorials: Generative AI](#), Northeastern University Library
- [Communication Studies: AI tools for your research](#), Northeastern University Library
- [Collaborating on Literature Reviews with AI](#), Daniel Serig, Northeastern Center for Advancing Teaching and Learning Through Research
- [Data Ethics: Understanding Big Data and Algorithmic Bias](#), Digital Integration Teaching Initiative
- [AI for Literature Reviews](#), Digital Integration Teaching Initiative
- [Scopus LibGuide: Scopus AI](#), Elsevier
- [Scopus AI Quick Reference Guide](#), Elsevier